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GST 114 (COMMUNICATION IN ENGLISH)

SELF HELP SHORT NOTES.

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KEY INFORMATION ABOUT THE MATERIAL:

1. **THE MATERIAL CONTAINS KEY DETAILS OF ALL THE TOPICS FOR THE COURSE GST COURSE GST 114; COMMUNICATION IN ENGLISH.**

2. **THERE ARE 10 DRAFTED PRACTICE MULTI-CHOICE QUESTIONS FROM EACH TOPIC.**

3. **THE ANSWERS TO THE PRACTICE QUESTIONS ARE AT THE END OF THE MATERIAL.**

4. **THIS MATERIAL DOES NOT IN ANY WAY REPRESENT/REPLACE AND/OR SERVE**

AS A SUBSTITUTE FOR LECTURERS' NOTES OR WORKBOOKS/TEXTBOOKS FOR STUDENT USE. THEREFORE, STUDENTS ARE ADVISED TO ATTEND CLASSES, TAKE LECTURES SERIOUSLY, AND TAKE DOWN NOTES. THIS MATERIAL ONLY SERVES AS A FORM OF SELF HELP FOR STUDENTS, AND CAN BE USED EFFECTIVELY FOR "BRUSH UP" AND PRACTICES.

ON THOSE NOTES, I, OBASI EMMANUEL CHIDINDU WISH YOU ALL THE BEST THIS SECOND SEMESTER, AND SUCCESS IN YOUR EXAMS FOR THE SEMESTER.

OBASI EMMANUEL CARES!

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COURSE OUTLINE:

1. ENGLISH WORD CLASSES: *LEXICAL AND GRAMMATICAL WORDS *DEFINITION *FORMS *FUNCTIONS * USAGE * CO- LOCATION

2. SENTENCE IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE: * TYPES * STRUCTURAL * FUNCTIONS * SIMPLE AND * COMPLEX

3. GRAMMAR AND USAGE: * TENSES * MOOD * MODERATING * CONCORD * ASPECT OF LANGUAGE USE IN EVERYDAY LIFE

4. LOGICAL AND CRITICAL THINKING/ REASONING METHODS * LOGIC * SYLLOGISMS * INDUCTIVE and DEDUCTIVE ARGUMENT * REASONING METHODS

*** ANALOGY GENERALIZATIONS**

5. WRITING ACTIVITIES: * PRE- WRITING * POST- WRITING * EDITING * PROOF READING * BRAINSTORMING * OUTLINING * PARAGRAPHING * TYPES OF WRITING * SUMMARY * ESSAY * LETTERS * CURRICULUM VITAL * REPORT WRITING * NOTE MAKING * BOOK REVIEW * MECHANISM OF WRITINGTOPIC

1.

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1: ENGLISH WORD CLASSES

1.1 Meaning of Word Classes

Word classes are categories into which words are grouped according to their grammatical behavior, form, and function in a sentence. In English, words do not function randomly; each word belongs to a class that determines how it can be used with other words. For example, a noun can name a person, place, thing, or idea, while a verb can show action or state of being. Word classes help speakers and writers understand sentence construction and correct usage. They are one of the most important foundations of grammar.

Word classes are also called parts of speech. Traditional grammar identifies classes such as nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs, pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, articles, and interjections. Modern grammar often groups words into **lexical words** and **grammatical words**. Lexical words carry meaning, while grammatical words help organize sentence structure. A clear understanding of word classes improves communication, accuracy, and fluency.

1.2 Lexical Words

Lexical words are content words because they carry the main meaning in a sentence. They are open-class items, meaning new words can continue to enter these classes as language grows. The major lexical word classes are nouns, verbs, adjectives, and adverbs. These words are essential because they provide the core information in a sentence. Without lexical words, communication would be incomplete or vague.

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Nouns

A noun is a word used to name a person, place, thing, quality, or idea. Examples include student, Lagos, pen, honesty, and freedom. Nouns may be common or proper, concrete or abstract, countable or uncountable. They can function as subjects, objects, complements, or objects of prepositions. For example, in “The student wrote an essay,” the noun “student” is the subject.

Verbs

A verb is a word that expresses action, occurrence, or state of being. Examples include run, eat, think, become, and appear. Verbs are central to sentence construction because every complete sentence needs a verb. Verbs change form to show tense, aspect, mood, and agreement. For example, “She walks,” “She walked,” and “She is walking” show different verb forms.

Adjectives

An adjective is a word that modifies or describes a noun or pronoun. It gives information about quality, size, color, number, shape, or condition. Examples include beautiful, tall, rich, two, and intelligent. Adjectives help make expression more precise and vivid. In “a tall building,” the adjective “tall” describes the noun “building.”

Adverbs

An adverb modifies a verb, adjective, another adverb, or sometimes a whole sentence. It often tells how, when, where, or to what extent something happens. Examples include quickly, yesterday, here, very, and carefully. In “She speaks clearly,” the adverb “clearly” modifies the verb “speaks.” Adverbs make language more specific and expressive.

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1.3 Grammatical Words

Grammatical words are function words because they help words in a sentence relate properly to one another. They do not usually carry strong lexical meaning on their own. Instead, they show structure, relationship, and grammatical meaning. These words belong to closed classes because new grammatical words are rarely added to the language. Examples include pronouns, prepositions, conjunctions, determiners, auxiliary verbs, and articles.

Pronouns

A pronoun is a word used in place of a noun to avoid repetition. Examples include I, you, he, she, it, we, they, this, that, and who. Pronouns help make writing smooth and less repetitive. For example, instead of saying "Tolu said Tolu will come later," we say "Tolu said she will come later."

Prepositions

A preposition shows the relationship between a noun or pronoun and another word in a sentence. It often indicates place, time, direction, cause, or manner. Examples include in, on, at, under, between, before, after, and with. In "The book is on the table," the preposition "on" shows location.

Conjunctions

A conjunction joins words, phrases, or clauses. Examples include and, but, or, because, although, and while. Conjunctions help create sentence flow and logical relationships. For example, "I wanted to go, but I was tired." The conjunction "but" shows contrast.

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Articles and Determiners

Articles are words used before nouns to specify whether the noun is definite or indefinite. The articles in English are a, an, and the. Determiners are broader and include words such as this, that, these, those, some, each, and many. They help identify quantity or specificity. For example, “the car” refers to a specific car, while “a car” refers to any car.

Auxiliary Verbs

Auxiliary verbs are helping verbs used with main verbs to form tenses, questions, negatives, and passive voice. Examples include be, have, and do, as well as modal auxiliaries such as can, must, and should. In “She is reading,” “is” helps form the present continuous tense. Auxiliary verbs are important for grammatical accuracy.

1.4 Forms of Word Classes

Forms refer to the different shapes a word may take depending on grammatical use. Word forms show number, tense, degree, comparison, or derivation. English is a language with many inflections and variations in form. A single word may appear in different forms but still belong to the same class. Understanding forms helps learners use words correctly in different contexts.

For nouns, form may show singular and plural: book/books, child/children. For verbs, forms include base form, past tense, past participle, and present participle: go, went, gone, going. For adjectives, forms may show comparison: fast, faster, fastest. Some words change form through affixation, such as happy to happiness or care to careful. Word forms are crucial for grammar and meaning.

1.5 Functions of Word Classes

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Function refers to the role a word plays in a sentence. A word class may have several functions depending on context. For example, a noun can function as a subject, object, or complement. A verb can function as the main action or as an auxiliary. A word's function is often determined by its position and the structure of the sentence. Identifying function is important because form alone does not always reveal usage.

For example, in "The boy kicked the ball," "boy" is the subject, "kicked" is the verb, and "ball" is the object. In "She is a doctor," "doctor" functions as a subject complement. In "He ran quickly," "quickly" modifies the verb "ran." Word class function helps explain how sentences are built and understood.

1.6 Usage of Word Classes

Usage is the correct and appropriate application of word classes in speech and writing. Good usage depends on choosing the right word class for the right context. Errors in usage can make a sentence unclear, unnatural, or ungrammatical. For example, saying "He is angrily" is incorrect because "angrily" is an adverb and cannot normally function as a subject complement. The correct sentence is "He is angry."

Good usage involves knowing whether a word should be used as a noun, verb, adjective, or adverb. It also involves agreement and placement in the sentence. In academic writing, correct usage is very important because it affects clarity and credibility. In everyday speech, good usage helps communication sound natural and polite.

1.7 Collocation

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Collocation refers to the natural combination of words that commonly occur together in a language. Some words sound correct together because speakers use them that way habitually. For example, we say make a decision, take a break, heavy rain, and fast food. Collocation is not always predictable from grammar alone. A sentence may be grammatically correct but still sound unnatural if collocation is wrong.

Collocation is important because it helps learners sound fluent and accurate. It is especially useful in academic English, business English, and formal writing. Some common errors happen when learners translate directly from their first language. For example, “do a decision” is incorrect because native usage favors “make a decision.” Mastery of collocation improves vocabulary depth and communication quality.

1.8 Summary of Word Classes

English word classes provide the structure of communication. Lexical words carry meaning, while grammatical words organize relationships. Word forms, functions, usage, and collocation all work together to produce meaningful sentences. A student who understands word classes will write and speak with greater confidence and precision. This topic is the foundation for all other areas of English grammar.

Practice Questions for Topic 1

1. Which of the following is a lexical word?

   A. In

   B. The

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C. Run

D. But

2. Which word class is used to replace a noun?

A. Pronoun

B. Preposition

C. Article

D. Conjunction

3. The word “carefully” is a:

A. Noun

B. Adjective

C. Verb

D. Adverb

4. Which of the following is a correct collocation?

A. Do a decision

B. Make a decision

C. Give a decision

D. Build a decision

5. In the sentence “The tall girl smiled,” the word “tall” is a:

A. Verb

B. Adjective

C. Adverb

D. Conjunction

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6. Which of the following is a grammatical word?

   A. Beautiful

   B. Quickly

   C. Under

   D. Student

7. “He is reading” contains an auxiliary verb:

   A. He

   B. Is

   C. Reading

   D. He is

8. The plural form of “child” is:
   A. Childs
   B. Childes
   C. Children
   D. Childrens

9. In “She sang softly,” “softly” functions as a:
   A. Noun
   B. Adjective
   C. Adverb
   D. Preposition

10. Collocation refers to:
    A. Sentence punctuation
    B. Natural word combination
    C. Word spelling
    D. Paragraph structure

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TOPIC 2: SENTENCE IN ENGLISH LANGUAGE

2.1 Meaning of Sentence

A sentence is a group of words that expresses a complete thought. It is the basic unit of communication in English. A sentence usually has a subject and a predicate, and it ends with appropriate punctuation such as a full stop, question mark, or exclamation mark. Without a complete sentence, communication becomes fragmented and unclear. Sentences can be short or long, simple or complex, but they must convey a complete meaning.

A sentence is different from a phrase or clause. A phrase does not always express a complete thought, while a sentence does. For example, “under the table” is a phrase, but “The book is under the table” is a sentence. Similarly, “when the bell rang” is a clause, but not a complete sentence on its own unless joined to an independent clause. Sentence construction is central to grammar, writing, and speaking.

2.2 Types of Sentences by Purpose

Sentences can be classified according to their purpose in communication.

Declarative Sentences

Declarative sentences make statements or give information. They are the most common type of sentence in English. Example: “The students are in class.” A declarative sentence usually ends with a full stop. Its purpose is to provide facts, ideas, or opinions.

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Interrogative Sentences

Interrogative sentences ask questions. They are used when the speaker wants information. Example: “Where are you going?” Interrogative sentences usually end with a question mark. They may be formed with wh-words or auxiliary verbs.

Imperative Sentences

Imperative sentences give commands, instructions, requests, or advice. Example: “Open the window.” The subject is often understood rather than stated directly. Imperative sentences may sound firm, polite, or urgent depending on context.

Exclamatory Sentences

Exclamatory sentences express strong feeling, surprise, or emotion. Example: “What a beautiful day!” They usually end with an exclamation mark. Exclamatory sentences make writing more expressive and emotional.

2.3 Structural Types of Sentences

Sentence structure depends on the number and relationship of clauses.

Simple Sentence

A simple sentence contains one independent clause. It has one subject and one predicate, though the subject or predicate may be compound. Example: “The girl danced.” Even if a sentence is short, it is still complete if it contains one independent clause. Simple sentences are useful for clarity and emphasis.

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Compound Sentence

A compound sentence contains two or more independent clauses joined by a coordinating conjunction, semicolon, or sometimes a colon. Example: “The rain fell, and the match was postponed.” Compound sentences show equality between ideas. They are useful when two related thoughts are equally important.

Complex Sentence

A complex sentence contains one independent clause and one or more dependent clauses. Example: “The match was postponed because the rain fell.” The dependent clause cannot stand alone. Complex sentences help show cause, time, condition, contrast, and other relationships.

Compound-Complex Sentence

A compound-complex sentence contains at least two independent clauses and one or more dependent clauses. Example: “The rain fell, and the match was postponed because the pitch was wet.” This type of sentence is more advanced and allows for richer expression. It is common in academic writing and sophisticated prose.

2.4 Functions of Sentences

The function of a sentence is the purpose it serves in communication. A sentence may inform, question, command, or exclaim. Function is related to but not the same as structure. For example, a declarative sentence can function as a statement, but it may also be used in other ways in context. Understanding sentence function helps speakers and writers choose the correct tone and style.

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Function is important in real communication because people do not only form grammatically correct sentences; they also use sentences to achieve social and practical goals. For instance, “Could you open the door?” is formally interrogative, but it functions as a polite request. This shows that sentence meaning depends on use, not only form. Good writers understand both grammar and communicative function.

2.5 Simple and Complex Sentences

A simple sentence expresses one complete idea using one independent clause. It is direct and easy to understand. Example: “The teacher entered the room.” Simple sentences are effective when clarity is the goal. They are common in instructions, announcements, and everyday speech.

A complex sentence combines one independent clause with one or more dependent clauses. Example: “The teacher entered the room after the bell rang.” Complex sentences make writing more detailed and connected. They allow the writer to show timing, reason, contrast, and condition. Good academic writing often uses complex sentences because they present ideas in a more developed way.

2.6 Sentence Punctuation

Proper punctuation is important in sentence construction. A full stop marks a declarative sentence, a question mark marks an interrogative sentence, and an exclamation mark marks an exclamatory sentence. Commas, semicolons, and colons may also be used in compound and complex sentence structures. Wrong punctuation can change meaning or make a sentence difficult to understand. Therefore, punctuation and sentence structure must work together.

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2.7 Importance of Sentence Mastery

Mastering sentence structure helps a student write clearly, speak confidently, and communicate logically. It improves performance in essays, reports, examinations, and public communication. Sentence mastery also reduces ambiguity and grammatical errors. In university-level communication, sentence quality is a major indicator of competence. A strong command of sentences supports all other language skills.

Practice Questions for Topic 2

1. A sentence must express:

   A. A word only

   B. A complete thought

   C. A noun only

   D. A phrase only

2. Which sentence type asks a question?

   A. Declarative

   B. Imperative

   C. Interrogative

   D. Exclamatory

3. “Please sit down.” is:

   A. Declarative

   B. Imperative

   C. Complex

   D. Exclamatory

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4. A simple sentence has:

   A. One independent clause

   B. Two independent clauses

   C. One dependent clause only

   D. No subject

5. A complex sentence contains:

   A. One independent clause and one or more dependent clauses

   B. Two independent clauses only

   C. One phrase only

   D. No clause

6. Which is a compound sentence?

   A. The boy laughed.

   B. The boy laughed because he was happy.

   C. The boy laughed, and his sister smiled.

   D. When the boy laughed.

7. “What a shame!” is:

   A. Declarative

   B. Interrogative

   C. Imperative

   D. Exclamatory

8. A dependent clause:

   A. Can stand alone

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B. Cannot stand alone

C. Has no verb

D. Has no subject

9. A semicolon may be used in:

A. Simple words only

B. Compound sentences

C. Spelling rules only

D. Pronouns only

10. Sentence mastery helps improve:

A. Grammar and communication

B. Handwriting only

C. Paper size

D. Vocabulary removal

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TOPIC 3: GRAMMAR AND USAGE

3.1 Meaning of Grammar

Grammar is the system of rules that governs how words combine to form meaningful sentences. It includes syntax, morphology, agreement, tense, aspect, mood, and sentence structure. Grammar is not just a set of restrictions; it is the framework that makes communication possible. Good grammar enables precision, clarity, and correctness. In academic and professional contexts, grammar is essential for effective expression.

Grammar also helps speakers and writers avoid confusion. Without grammar, words may appear in random order and meaning may be lost. For example, “Teacher the entered room” is not correct English because the word order is wrong. Proper grammar organizes language into understandable patterns. This makes it foundational to communication in English.

3.2 Tenses

Tense refers to the way verbs show the time of an action or state. English has three main tenses: present, past, and future. Each of these may appear in simple, continuous, perfect, and perfect continuous forms. Tense helps a reader or listener know whether something happened before, is happening now, or will happen later. Correct tense use is necessary for coherent communication.

Present Tense

Present tense refers to actions happening now, habits, general truths, or scheduled events. Examples include “She writes,” “She is writing,” “She has written,” and “She has been writing.”

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Present tense is often used in narration, descriptions, and daily communication. It gives immediacy and relevance.

Past Tense

Past tense refers to actions completed before now. Examples include “She wrote,” “She was writing,” “She had written,” and “She had been writing.” Past tense is used to recount events, explain previous actions, and narrate stories. It is important in historical writing and personal accounts.

Future Tense

Future tense refers to actions that will happen later. Examples include “She will write,” “She will be writing,” “She will have written,” and “She will have been writing.” Future tense may be expressed with modal verbs, auxiliary structures, or contextual expressions of time. It is common in planning and prediction.

3.3 Aspect

Aspect describes the internal time structure of an action, especially whether it is complete, continuing, or repeated. Unlike tense, which shows time, aspect shows how the action is viewed. The major aspects in English are simple, progressive/continuous, perfect, and perfect progressive. Aspect is very important because it adds precision to tense usage. A good understanding of aspect helps avoid tense errors.

The progressive aspect shows ongoing action, such as “She is reading.” The perfect aspect shows completed action with relevance to another time, such as “She has finished.” The perfect

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progressive aspect shows duration, such as “She has been studying for two hours.” Aspect helps the writer express actions more accurately. It is especially important in advanced grammar.

3.4 Mood

Mood refers to the attitude of the speaker or writer toward the action or state expressed by the verb. It shows whether the sentence is stating a fact, giving a command, or expressing a wish or possibility. English has three main moods: indicative, imperative, and subjunctive. Mood influences the tone and purpose of a sentence. It is a key part of effective language use.

The indicative mood is used for facts and questions. Example: “She is a student.” The imperative mood is used for commands and requests. Example: “Close the door.” The subjunctive mood is used for wishes, recommendations, and unreal or hypothetical situations. Example: “It is important that he be present.” Mood helps the writer shape meaning and attitude.

3.5 Modality

Modality refers to the linguistic expression of possibility, necessity, obligation, permission, ability, or certainty. It is often shown through modal verbs such as can, could, may, might, must, shall, should, will, and would. Modality allows speakers to be polite, cautious, or forceful depending on the situation. It is very common in speech and writing.

For example, “You must submit your assignment” expresses obligation. “You may leave now” expresses permission. “She can speak French” expresses ability. “It might rain later” expresses possibility. Modality gives language flexibility and subtlety.

3.6 Concord

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Concord means grammatical agreement between related sentence elements. The most common type is subject-verb agreement, where the verb must match the subject in number and person. For example, “He goes” is correct, while “He go” is incorrect. Concord also applies to pronouns, determiners, and sometimes nouns and adjectives. Errors in concord are among the most frequent grammatical mistakes in English.

Examples of correct concord include “The students are here” and “Each boy has a book.” Problems often occur when a writer is distracted by intervening words or collective nouns. Good concord improves clarity and grammatical accuracy. It is especially important in examinations and formal writing.

3.7 Grammar in Everyday Life

Grammar is used in everyday communication, including conversation, texting, formal writing, social media, business, and academic work. In informal settings, people may bend grammatical rules, but standard grammar remains important in serious communication. Good grammar helps people express ideas clearly and avoid misunderstanding. It also shapes the impression others have of a speaker or writer. In a university setting, grammar is essential to success.

Grammar is not only about correctness; it also supports meaning, politeness, and style. A well-structured sentence can make a message easier to understand and more persuasive. Poor grammar may distract readers from the intended message. Therefore, grammar has practical value beyond classroom study. It is part of effective real-life communication.

Practice Questions for Topic 3

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1. Grammar is the system of:

   A. Drawing pictures

   B. Rules for sentence formation

   C. Alphabet arrangement

   D. Sound production only

2. Tense primarily shows:

   A. Word class

   B. Time of action

   C. Sentence length

   D. Paragraph order

3. “She is singing” is in:

   A. Simple present

   B. Present continuous

   C. Past perfect

   D. Future perfect

4. The mood used for commands is:

   A. Indicative

   B. Imperative

   C. Subjunctive

   D. Passive

5. Modality is expressed by:

   A. Nouns only

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B. Modal verbs

C. Articles only

D. Adjectives only

6. Which of the following shows obligation?

A. May

B. Must

C. Might

D. Could

7. Concord means:

A. Sentence punctuation

B. Grammatical agreement

C. Word stress

D. Spelling pattern

8. Which sentence is correct?

A. They was late.

B. He go home.

C. She writes well.

D. The boy are here.

9. The subjunctive mood is often used for:

A. Commands only

B. Wishes and hypothetical situations

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C. Past narration only

D. Questions only

10. Aspect shows:

A. The internal time structure of an action

B. The color of a noun

C. The number of letters in a word

D. The type of punctuation

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TOPIC 4: LOGICAL AND CRITICAL THINKING / REASONING METHODS

4.1 Meaning of Logic

Logic is the study of correct reasoning and valid argument. It helps people determine whether conclusions follow properly from given statements or evidence. Logic is not merely about winning arguments; it is about thinking clearly and soundly. A logical person can identify weak reasoning, contradictions, and unsupported claims. Logic is essential in academics, law, science, and everyday decision-making.

Logic helps distinguish between truth and validity. A true conclusion does not always arise from valid reasoning, and a valid form of reasoning may still contain false premises. Therefore, logic examines both structure and content of arguments. Good logic helps people make fair judgments. It also improves writing and speaking by making arguments more convincing.

4.2 Arguments

An argument in logic is not a quarrel; it is a set of statements in which one or more statements support another statement called the conclusion. The supporting statements are called premises. The conclusion is the claim being defended or established. Arguments can be strong, weak, valid, invalid, sound, or unsound depending on their structure and evidence. Understanding arguments is the first step in critical thinking.

For example: “All students read books. Emeka is a student. Therefore, Emeka reads books.” This is an argument because the premises support the conclusion. In real life, people present arguments in essays, debates, and conversations. Critical thinkers examine whether the premises are true and whether the conclusion follows logically. This skill is necessary for academic success.

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4.3 Syllogisms

A syllogism is a form of deductive reasoning that contains two premises and a conclusion. The major premise is a general statement, the minor premise is a specific statement, and the conclusion follows from both. Syllogisms are used to test reasoning in a clear and structured way. They are common in formal logic and academic discussions.

Example:

- All humans are mortal.
- Socrates is a human.
- Therefore, Socrates is mortal.

This is a valid syllogism because the conclusion follows necessarily from the premises. Syllogisms help reveal whether a conclusion is logically supported. They are useful in law, philosophy, and debate. Learning syllogistic reasoning improves precision in thought.

4.4 Inductive Reasoning

Inductive reasoning moves from specific observations to general conclusions. It is based on patterns, evidence, or repeated experiences. Unlike deduction, induction does not guarantee certainty; it produces probable conclusions. For example, if several observed metal objects expand when heated, one may conclude that metals expand when heated. This conclusion is reasonable, though it may still be revised if new evidence appears.

Induction is important in science because scientists observe data and form theories. It is also used in everyday life when people make decisions based on experience. The strength of an inductive

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argument depends on the quality and quantity of evidence. Weak induction may lead to hasty generalization. Therefore, careful observation is necessary.

4.5 Deductive Reasoning

Deductive reasoning moves from general principles to specific conclusions. If the premises are true and the reasoning is valid, the conclusion must be true. Deduction is used when applying rules, laws, or theories to particular cases. It is a powerful form of reasoning because it gives certainty when properly constructed.

For example:

- All men are mortal.
- Obasi is a man.
- Therefore, Obasi is mortal.

This is deductive because the conclusion follows from a general rule. Deduction is common in mathematics, law, and formal argument. It allows one to test whether specific cases fit general principles. Deductive reasoning is central to logical analysis.

4.6 Reasoning Methods

Reasoning methods are the ways people think through problems, draw conclusions, and support claims. The major methods include deduction, induction, analogy, and generalization. Each method has its place in communication and problem-solving. Strong reasoning depends on evidence, coherence, and relevance. Poor reasoning often comes from assumptions, bias, or weak evidence.

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Reasoning is used in academic essays, debates, policy discussions, and everyday choices. For example, a student reasons deductively when applying a rule in an exam. The same student reasons inductively when observing trends in study habits. Critical thinking requires selecting the right reasoning method for the task. Good reasoning helps people avoid mistakes and false conclusions.

4.7 Analogy

Analogy is a reasoning method that compares one thing with another in order to explain, clarify, or support an idea. It works by showing that because two things are alike in some respects, they may be alike in another respect as well. Analogies are useful in teaching and persuasion. For example, a teacher may compare the brain to a computer to explain how information is processed.

However, analogies must be used carefully because two things may be similar in one respect but different in another. A weak analogy can mislead the audience. A good analogy is based on relevant similarities. Analogies are helpful in daily explanation, academic writing, and debate. They make abstract ideas easier to understand.

4.8 Generalization

Generalization is a conclusion drawn from several examples or observations. It is a common form of inductive reasoning. For example, if many students in a class study regularly and perform well, one may generalize that regular study improves performance. Generalization is useful but must be supported by enough evidence. If based on too few examples, it becomes a hasty generalization.

Generalization is often used in social observation, research, and decision-making. It can help people identify trends and patterns. However, critical thinking requires checking whether the

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sample is wide and fair enough. Good generalization avoids stereotypes and false claims. It is a valuable but delicate reasoning tool.

4.9 Critical Thinking

Critical thinking is the ability to analyze information carefully before accepting or rejecting it. It involves asking questions, checking evidence, identifying assumptions, and evaluating arguments. A critical thinker does not accept claims blindly. Instead, such a person weighs facts, logic, and relevance. This skill is essential in education and life.

Critical thinking helps students write better essays, solve problems, and detect fallacies. It also helps in reading textbooks, newspapers, and online content responsibly. In a world filled with information, critical thinking is necessary for judgment and self-defense against misinformation. It encourages independence of thought. It is one of the most valuable academic skills.

Practice Questions for Topic 4

1. Logic is concerned with:

   A. Handwriting

   B. Correct reasoning

   C. Paragraph indentation

   D. Word spelling

2. An argument consists of:

   A. Letters and numbers

   B. Premises and a conclusion

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C. A title and subtitle

D. Nouns and verbs only

3. A syllogism has:

A. One premise only

B. Two premises and a conclusion

C. Four conclusions

D. No conclusion

4. Inductive reasoning moves from:

A. General to specific

B. Specific to general

C. False to true

D. Opinion to fact only

5. Deductive reasoning moves from:

A. Specific to general

B. General to specific

C. Random to exact

D. Unknown to known only

6. Which of the following is an example of analogy?

A. Comparing the mind to a computer

B. Listing verbs

C. Counting syllables

D. Rearranging paragraphs

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7. Generalization is based on:

   A. One example only

   B. Several observations

   C. No evidence

   D. Random guessing

8. A strong argument must have:

   A. True premises and valid reasoning

   B. Long sentences only

   C. Fancy words only

   D. A title page

9. Critical thinking involves:

   A. Accepting all claims immediately

   B. Evaluating evidence carefully

   C. Ignoring assumptions

   D. Avoiding questions

10. A hasty generalization is:

    A. A careful conclusion from enough evidence

    B. A conclusion from too little evidence

    C. A perfect deduction

    D. A type of punctuation

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TOPIC 5: WRITING ACTIVITIES

5.1 Meaning of Writing Activities

Writing activities are the processes involved in producing written communication. Writing is not a single action but a sequence of related stages that include planning, drafting, revising, editing, and finalizing. In academic settings, writing is one of the most important tools for assessment and communication. Good writing shows clear thought, organization, and accuracy. It is a skill that improves with practice and attention to process.

Writing activities are important because they help writers develop ideas and express them effectively. A good written work does not appear suddenly; it is created through careful preparation and review. The writing process also helps the writer discover weaknesses and improve clarity. Since communication in university life depends heavily on writing, students must understand each stage well. This topic covers both the process and the different types of writing.

5.2 Pre-Writing

Pre-writing is the stage before actual drafting begins. It involves thinking about the topic, gathering ideas, and organizing material. This stage may include brainstorming, freewriting, note-making, reading, researching, or discussing the topic with others. Pre-writing helps the writer choose the best direction and avoid confusion later. It is the foundation of effective writing.

A writer who skips pre-writing may struggle with poor organization and lack of focus. During pre-writing, the writer asks questions such as: What is the topic? What is my purpose? Who is my audience? What points should I include? These questions guide planning. Pre-writing saves time and improves the quality of the final product.

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5.3 Brainstorming

Brainstorming is a pre-writing technique used to generate many ideas quickly. The aim is quantity first, not immediate quality. At this stage, ideas are collected freely without too much criticism. Brainstorming can be done alone or in groups. It helps students discover useful points they might otherwise overlook.

For example, if the topic is "The importance of education," a student may list ideas such as knowledge, employment, social development, confidence, and national growth. Later, these ideas can be selected and arranged logically. Brainstorming encourages creativity and reduces writer's block. It is especially helpful for essay writing and project planning.

5.4 Outlining

Outlining is the process of arranging ideas in a logical order before writing. It shows the main points and supporting details in a structured form. A good outline helps a writer stay focused and avoid repetition. It also makes drafting faster and clearer. Outlining is especially important in essays, reports, and research writing.

An outline may be informal or formal. A formal outline uses headings, subheadings, and numbering to show hierarchy. For example, a topic may be divided into introduction, body, and conclusion. Each body point may have supporting subpoints. Outlining improves coherence and organization.

5.5 Drafting

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Drafting is the stage where the writer turns ideas into full sentences and paragraphs. At this stage, the writer focuses more on content than on perfection. The first draft may contain errors, but that is normal. Drafting allows the writer to develop ideas in written form. It is the bridge between planning and revision.

A good draft should follow the outline and address the topic clearly. Writers should avoid trying to perfect every sentence during the first draft. The purpose is to get ideas on paper. After drafting, the writer can revise and improve the work. Drafting is a necessary step in professional and academic writing.

5.6 Revising

Revising means rethinking and improving the content, organization, and expression of a piece of writing. It goes beyond correcting mistakes. A writer revises to make sure ideas are clear, relevant, and well supported. This may involve adding details, removing weak points, or changing the order of paragraphs. Revising improves the quality of the message.

Revision is often done after reading the draft carefully. A writer may ask: Is the topic fully addressed? Are the ideas well organized? Is anything missing? Revising is a major part of the writing process because it strengthens the work. Good writers usually revise more than once.

5.7 Editing

Editing is the stage where the writer checks grammar, spelling, punctuation, word choice, and sentence structure. Unlike revising, which deals more with ideas and organization, editing focuses on correctness and style. It helps make the writing polished and professional. An edited work is easier to read and more credible.

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Editing may include changing awkward expressions, reducing repetition, correcting tense errors, and improving vocabulary choice. A writer should read carefully and look out for common mistakes. Editing is essential because even a good idea can look weak if it is poorly expressed. It is a key part of good writing practice.

5.8 Proofreading

Proofreading is the final stage of checking a written work for errors. It involves looking for typing mistakes, missing words, punctuation errors, spelling mistakes, and formatting problems. Proofreading should be done after revision and editing because it is the last quality check before submission. It ensures that the final copy is clean and accurate.

A writer should proofread slowly and carefully, preferably after taking a short break from the work. This makes it easier to spot errors. Proofreading may seem small, but it makes a big difference in presentation. A careless final copy can reduce the score of an otherwise good assignment. Therefore, proofreading is a necessary habit for serious writers.

5.9 Post-Writing

Post-writing refers to the activities carried out after drafting, revising, editing, and proofreading. It includes final checking, reflection, and sometimes publishing or submitting the work. Post-writing helps the writer evaluate the effectiveness of the piece. It may also involve noting strengths and weaknesses for future improvement. This stage completes the writing process.

Post-writing is important because writing should not end with submission alone. The writer should learn from the experience and use feedback for growth. In academic work, post-writing may

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include making corrections after receiving comments. This stage supports continuous improvement. It closes the cycle of writing and learning.

5.10 Paragraphing

Paragraphing is the practice of organizing writing into paragraphs. A paragraph is a group of related sentences centered on one main idea. Good paragraphing gives writing unity, coherence, and readability. Each paragraph should have a clear topic sentence, supporting sentences, and sometimes a concluding sentence. Paragraphing helps the reader follow the argument or explanation.

A weak paragraph may contain too many ideas or fail to develop one idea properly. Good paragraphing requires logical arrangement and transition between points. In essays and reports, paragraphs are essential building blocks. Strong paragraphing improves structure and presentation. It is one of the marks of mature writing.

5.11 Types of Writing

Writing takes many forms depending on purpose and audience.

Summary Writing

Summary writing is the shortening of a passage while keeping its main points. A good summary should be concise, accurate, and objective. It must not include personal opinions or unnecessary details. Summary writing develops comprehension and the ability to identify key ideas. It is useful in academics, note-taking, and research.

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Essay Writing

An essay is a structured piece of writing on a specific topic. It usually has an introduction, body, and conclusion. Essays may be descriptive, narrative, argumentative, expository, or reflective. Good essays are clear, well-organized, and supported by relevant ideas. Essay writing is central to university communication.

Letter Writing

Letters are written messages used to communicate with others. They may be formal or informal. Formal letters are used for official purposes such as applications, complaints, and requests. Informal letters are used for personal communication. Letter writing requires correct format, tone, and salutation.

Curriculum Vitae

A curriculum vitae is a summary of a person's educational background, skills, experience, and achievements. It is used for job and academic applications. A CV must be clear, accurate, and professionally arranged. It usually includes personal data, education, experience, skills, and referees. A strong CV improves the chance of selection.

Report Writing

Report writing presents facts, findings, observations, or recommendations in an organized and objective way. Reports are common in academic, business, and official settings. They may include title, introduction, body, findings, conclusion, and recommendations. Good report writing is clear, concise, and factual.

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Note Making

Note making is the process of writing down key ideas in a brief form for study or reference. It helps students remember important information and review efficiently. Good notes should be short, clear, and organized. Note making is different from copying because it involves selecting and condensing information. It is a powerful study skill.

Book Review

A book review is a critical assessment of a book. It usually summarizes the content, examines the quality of the writing, and gives an opinion. A good review is balanced, fair, and insightful. It should not merely retell the story. Book reviews help readers decide whether a book is valuable or relevant.

5.12 Mechanism of Writing

The mechanism of writing refers to the technical elements that make writing correct and readable. These include spelling, punctuation, capitalization, sentence formation, and handwriting. Good mechanics help prevent misunderstanding and improve presentation. A writer who ignores mechanics may communicate poorly even if the ideas are good. Therefore, mechanical accuracy is essential.

Mechanics also include the correct use of commas, full stops, apostrophes, quotation marks, and paragraphing. Capital letters are used for sentence beginnings, proper nouns, and titles where appropriate. Spelling errors can weaken an academic paper. Mastery of writing mechanics shows discipline and attention to detail.

5.13 Importance of Writing Skills

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Writing skills are important in school, work, and daily life. They help students answer examination questions, prepare assignments, and communicate professionally. Writing also improves thinking because it forces the writer to organize ideas logically. Strong writing skills are valuable in every discipline. They are a major part of academic success.

Practice Questions for Topic 5

1. Pre-writing is the stage where a writer:

   A. Submits the work

   B. Plans and organizes ideas

   C. Proofreads only

   D. Prints the final copy

2. Brainstorming means:

   A. Checking spelling only

   B. Generating many ideas quickly

   C. Writing a CV

   D. Summarizing a book

3. Outlining helps the writer to:

   A. Arrange ideas logically

   B. Ignore the topic

   C. Create punctuation errors

   D. Remove paragraphs

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4. Drafting is the stage where:

   A. Ideas are turned into full writing

   B. Only spelling is checked

   C. The final copy is submitted

   D. Ideas are deleted

5. Revising mainly deals with:

   A. Content and organization

   B. Paper size

   C. Handwriting style only

   D. Typeface only

6. Editing focuses mainly on:

   A. Grammar and correctness

   B. Random idea generation

   C. Research only

   D. Topic selection only

7. Proofreading is done to check:

   A. Typing and spelling errors

   B. Only ideas

   C. Only paragraph titles

   D. Only outlines

8. A paragraph should contain:

   A. Several unrelated ideas

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B. One main idea

C. No sentence

D. Only a title

9. A CV is used for:

A. Job or academic applications

B. Story writing

C. Poetry analysis only

D. Letter decoration

10. Report writing should be:

A. Informal and emotional

B. Objective and organized

C. Random and casual

D. Very short and vague

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ANSWERS TO ALL QUESTIONS

Topic 1 Answers

1. C
2. A
3. D
4. B
5. B
6. C
7. B
8. C
9. C
10. B

Topic 2 Answers

1. B
2. C
3. B
4. A
5. A

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6. C
7. D
8. B
9. B
10. A

Topic 3 Answers

1. B
2. B
3. B
4. B
5. B
6. B
7. B
8. C
9. B
10. A

Topic 4 Answers

1. B
2. B

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3. B
4. B
5. B
6. A
7. B
8. A
9. B
10. B

Topic 5 Answers

1. B
2. B
3. A
4. A
5. A
6. A
7. A
8. B
9. A
10. B

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